

Verify emergency information

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QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Check the source, time, exact location and evidence before acting on or sharing an emergency message. Compare independent sources when possible. A forwarded screenshot, logo or urgent voice note is not verification. Act on obvious immediate danger without waiting for a post to be confirmed.

Do now.

- ☐ **Check the original**
01 Find the actual organisation or person through an independently known channel. A familiar-looking account or copied badge can be fake.
- ☐ **Check place and time**
02 Confirm the affected street, region and date. Old footage and information from another country can appear current when forwarded.
- ☐ **Compare independent information**
03 Use radio, direct trusted observations and verified humanitarian or official sources as appropriate. Several reposts of the same claim are not independent confirmation.
- ☐ **Separate facts from guesses**
04 Write what is confirmed and what remains uncertain. Do not treat a claimed ceasefire, route, water safety notice or aid offer as certain without recent verification.
- ☐ **Share carefully**
05 Forward only necessary verified information with its time and source. Protect live locations and personal information. Correct earlier messages if they prove wrong.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If connectivity fails, use the observations you can obtain safely and your written plans. Do not travel into danger to confirm a rumour or follow a single anonymous message.

Watch for.

Verification should not delay escape from visible fire, rising water or another immediate hazard. No source can guarantee that conditions remain unchanged.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group. Make decisions around the least mobile person, not the fastest; avoid splitting the family without a clear, safe way to reconnect. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: check the original. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. Verification should not delay escape from visible fire, rising water or another immediate hazard. No source can guarantee that conditions remain unchanged.

Keep essentials within reach.

For verify emergency information, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: If connectivity fails, use the observations you can obtain safely and your written plans. Do not travel into danger to confirm a rumour or follow a single anonymous message. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Keep a short list of known sources saved offline, including non-government humanitarian sources. Choose information based on reliability and relevance, not simply whether it is official or unofficial.

First decision: Check the original

Find the actual organisation or person through an independently known channel. A familiar-looking account or copied badge can be fake. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

If connectivity fails, use the observations you can obtain safely and your written plans. Do not travel into danger to confirm a rumour or follow a single anonymous message. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

Verification should not delay escape from visible fire, rising water or another immediate hazard. No source can guarantee that conditions remain unchanged. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

Check the source, time, exact location and evidence before acting on or sharing an emergency message. Compare independent sources when possible. A forwarded screenshot, logo or urgent voice note is not verification. Act on obvious immediate danger without waiting for a post to be confirmed. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For verify emergency information, keep the specific hazard in view: Verification should not delay escape from visible fire, rising water or another immediate hazard. No source can guarantee that conditions remain unchanged.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Share carefully. Forward only necessary verified information with its time and source. Protect live locations and personal information. Correct earlier messages if they prove wrong. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

Emergency alerts · official guidance

<https://www.ready.gov/alerts>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/verify-information/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.